TASK - 5 {A}

Cybercrime Case Study: Ransomware Attack

5.1 What is Ransomware?

Ransomware is a type of malware that locks or encrypts files on a system and demands money to unlock them. It is commonly used by cybercriminals to target valuable data and force victims into paying quickly.

5.2 How It Typically Happens

- An employee receives an email that looks genuine, like a report or invoice.
- The attachment is opened without much suspicion.
- The malicious file installs ransomware in the system.
- The virus spreads quietly to other connected computers.
- Files get encrypted, and access is completely blocked.
- A ransom message appears asking for payment to recover data.

5.3 Who is Usually Targeted

- Hospitals and labs that store sensitive data
- Small businesses that lack strong security
- Colleges and institutions
- Government offices
- Even individuals with important personal files

5.4 Consequences of the Attack

- Important data becomes inaccessible
- Financial loss due to ransom or recovery efforts
- Delay in services and work
- Risk of sensitive data being leaked
- Loss of trust among clients or patients

5.5 Conclusion

This case shows how a simple mistake, like opening an unknown attachment, can lead to serious consequences. It highlights the need to be careful while using emails and to maintain proper backups. Being aware of such threats can help prevent these situations.